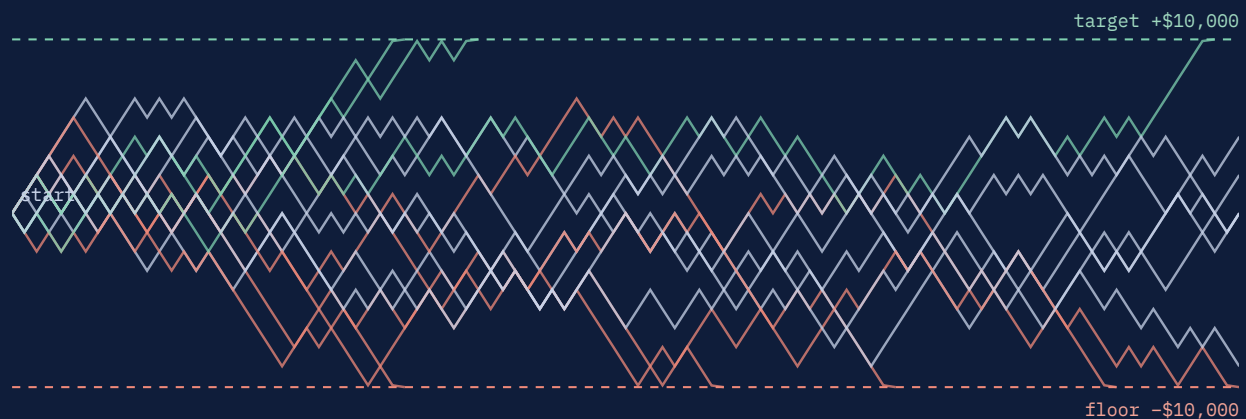


The Prop Firm Option

Why a funded-account challenge has positive expected value for a trader with no predictive skill, exactly how large that value is, how to get it as fast as possible, and how to run it inside the firm's rules.



Part 1 · The mathematics, from zero

Part 2 · Execution, step by step

Educational analysis, not financial advice. Prop-firm accounts are simulated and payouts ("rewards") are paid at the firm's discretion under its terms. Every figure in this document assumes the firm pays. In the execution plan about three attempts in four lose their full fee; after one month the chance of being ahead is about 5%, and individual results vary enormously. Firms change rules and prices often; check the current terms before acting. Prop firms require traders to be adults (18+). Do not use money you cannot afford to lose.

What is in this document

Key results at a glance

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Key results at a glance

Figures are for 100K accounts with FTMO's 2-Step as the reference. "Zero skill" means every trade's direction is no better than a coin flip. Every figure assumes the firm pays every payout it owes.

Quantity	Value	Where
Chance a zero-skill trader passes FTMO Phase 1 / Phase 2 / both	50% / 67% / 33%	Ch. 3–4
Average total paid by a funded account	$80\% \times \$10,000 + \text{refund}$	Ch. 5
Expected value per attempt, no costs (exact)	+\$2,235	Ch. 6
Trades needed per phase; time per phase	$A \cdot B \div (k L^2); \propto (\text{stop} \div \text{risk})^2$	Ch. 8
Most efficient instrument at FTMO (move per unit of cost)	US100 (Nasdaq)	Ch. 9
Crypto (24/7) efficiency compared with US100	10–20%	Ch. 9
Fast plan: US100, stop 0.75 hourly moves, 1 : 3, risk 1.5%	+\$1,429 per attempt	Ch. 10
Average length of a fast-plan attempt; median time to first payout	18 days; 27 days	Ch. 10, 23
Fast plan, expected value per month per FTMO slot	≈ \$2,400	Ch. 10
Same plan at The5ers / FundingPips / FTMO 1-Step	≈ \$3,200 / \$3,000 / \$2,900	Ch. 10
Fast plan on the real 2024–26 Nasdaq price path	+\$2,076 ± \$372	Ch. 10
Chance one slot is ahead after 1 / 6 / 12 months	5% / 69% / 88%	Ch. 10
Version 1 slow plan (EURUSD, 1% risk, wide stops)	≈ \$70 per month	Ch. 14
The earlier PDFs' own protocol on real data	-\$173 per attempt	Ch. 14–15

SIX IDEAS TO KEEP

1. **A trade with no skill is a fair bet.** Stop S and target T win with probability $S \div (S + T)$. Real data agrees to about one percentage point.
2. **Your pass chance is fixed by the rules.** It equals distance to floor $\div$ (distance to floor + distance to target), whatever the sizing.
3. **The value is the loss allowance.** In a fair game, the profits withdrawn over a funded account's life average the allowance the firm lets you lose; you keep the split.
4. **Time is the second half of the answer.** Trades per phase fall with the square of risk per trade, and time per trade rises with the square of the stop. Higher reward-to-risk cuts costs without adding time.
5. **Choose the instrument by movement per unit of cost**, not by trading hours or leverage. The Nasdaq CFD wins at FTMO. Crypto loses despite trading 24/7.
6. **The counterparty is the real risk.** Payouts are discretionary and firms can fail. Part 2 stays inside the firm's risk guidance and cannot remove that risk.

PART 1

The mathematics

Everything is built from two facts: a fair game stays fair however you play it, and money paid out has to come from somewhere. No prior knowledge of probability or trading is assumed.

The contract you are buying

A proprietary trading firm ("prop firm") sells evaluations. You pay a fee and receive a **simulated** trading account. Nothing you trade reaches a real market and you can never lose more than the fee. If you meet the firm's targets without breaking its loss limits, you get a "funded" account, still simulated, on which the firm pays you a share of the profits you make. Those payments are called *rewards* or *payouts*.

We use FTMO's 100K 2-Step Challenge as the worked example throughout. Chapter 11 extends the analysis to 37 account types at 16 firms.

Stage	You must reach	You fail if	Other rules
Phase 1 (Challenge)	\$110,000 (+\$10,000)	Equity $\leq$ \$90,000, or you lose \$5,000 in one day	At least 4 trading days; no time limit
Phase 2 (Verification)	\$105,000 (+\$5,000), starting again from \$100,000	Same: floor \$90,000, \$5,000 per day	At least 4 trading days; no time limit
Funded (FTMO Account)	No target	Same floor and daily limit	You keep 80% of withdrawn profit; first payout after 14 days, then every 14 days; the €540 fee is refunded with your first payout

Source: FTMO trading objectives and FAQ, October 2026. The maximum loss is *static*: the floor stays at \$90,000 however high the balance goes.

Words you need

- **Balance** is the account value counting only closed trades. **Equity** also counts the open trade's floating profit or loss. FTMO's limits are checked on equity, in real time.
- **Maximum loss (the floor)**. If equity touches \$90,000 the account is closed. We call the distance from the current balance down to the floor B (it starts at \$10,000).
- **Daily loss limit**. You may not lose more than \$5,000 (5% of the starting balance) within one day, measured from the balance at midnight Prague time, open trades included.
- **Profit target**. The distance from the current balance up to the target is called A.
- **Profit split**. The share of withdrawn profit you keep: 80% at FTMO (90% through its scaling plan).
- **Stop-loss and take-profit**. Orders that close a trade automatically at a loss of S dollars or a profit of T dollars. A trade with both attached is called a **bracket**. Its **reward-to-risk ratio (RR)** is $T : S$.

Why this is an option, and what kind

Your worst case is losing the fee. Your best case has no fixed ceiling. A payoff with a capped downside and an open upside is what finance calls an *option*, and the fee is its price. The question this document answers is whether the option is worth more than its price to someone who cannot

predict the market. Chapters 2 to 6 show that it is, and by how much. Note what this does *not* say. The value does not come from "volatility" in general, and it does not depend on trading in any clever way. Chapter 5 shows exactly where it comes from.

Probability from zero

2.1 Probability and expected value

A **probability** is a number between 0 and 1 saying how often something happens in the long run. A fair coin lands heads with probability $\frac{1}{2}$.

The **expected value** (EV) of a bet is the average result per bet if you repeated it many times. You get it by multiplying each outcome by its probability and adding up.

EXPECTED VALUE

$$EV = p_1 \times outcome_1 + p_2 \times outcome_2 + \dots$$

Example. You win \$10 on heads and lose \$10 on tails: $EV = \frac{1}{2} \times 10 + \frac{1}{2} \times (-10) = 0$. You win \$20 on heads and lose \$10 on tails: $EV = \frac{1}{2} \times 20 - \frac{1}{2} \times 10 = +\5 .

Expected values **add up**. The EV of ten bets is the sum of their ten EVs, whether or not the bets are connected to each other. This one fact will matter a lot in Chapter 13 (hedging).

2.2 Fair games

A bet is **fair** when its EV is zero. A game made of fair bets has a remarkable property: **no way of choosing your bets can change the fact that your expected total is zero**. You can bet big or small, stop when ahead, double after losses. If every individual bet is fair, the expected result of the whole sequence is still zero. Mathematicians call such a process a *martingale*, and the formal version of this fact is the *optional stopping theorem*. Its conditions (bets of bounded size, and a stopping rule that ends the game in finite expected time) are all met by the rules in this document.

2.3 One trade is one bet

Suppose you buy EURUSD and attach a stop 50 pips below and a target 50 pips above. If you have no information about direction, the price is as likely to reach either level first. The bet wins \$T or loses \$S. What is the probability p of winning?

With no skill, the price process has no drift, so the trade is a fair bet before costs: its EV must be zero.

WIN PROBABILITY OF A ZERO-SKILL BRACKET

$$p \times T - (1 - p) \times S = 0 \Rightarrow p = S \div (S + T)$$

Risk : reward	Stop S	Target T	Win probability $S/(S+T)$
1 : 0.1	\$5,000	\$500	90.9%
1 : 1	\$5,000	\$5,000	50.0%
1 : 2	\$5,000	\$10,000	33.3%

Risk : reward	Stop S	Target T	Win probability $S/(S+T)$
1 : 3	\$5,000	\$15,000	25.0%

Higher reward always comes with lower probability, in exactly the proportion that keeps the bet fair. A big target is not "better" and a small one is not "safer". They are the same bet with a different shape.

2.4 Does real data agree?

We tested this on every hour of EURUSD from 18 December 2023 to 2 October 2026. Each test trade picks a random direction and a random entry hour on a weekday, then follows the real price until the stop or target is hit. The results below are before costs.

Stop / target (pips)	Fair value $S/(S+T)$	Measured win rate	95% range
25 / 25	50.0%	50.4%	± 0.7
50 / 50	50.0%	50.3%	± 0.7
55 / 55	50.0%	49.7%	± 0.6
100 / 100	50.0%	50.0%	± 0.7
78 / 39 (1 : 0.5)	66.7%	67.6%	± 0.5
39 / 78 (1 : 2)	33.3%	32.1%	± 0.5
25 / 100 (1 : 4)	20.0%	20.3%	± 0.5

The formula holds closely. Symmetric brackets come out at 50% within noise. There is a small tilt in this sample: far targets (1 : 2) hit about one point less often than fair, and near targets slightly more often, which is mild short-term mean reversion. That is one reason Part 2 uses 1 : 1. The earlier documents claimed an "effective win rate" of 48.5%. The data does not support it. The only systematic drag is the trading cost, which Chapter 7 handles separately.

Reaching a target before a floor

Each challenge phase asks one question: starting from your current balance, will you reach the target (A dollars above) before you hit the floor (B dollars below)? This is the oldest problem in probability, known as the *gambler's ruin*.

3.1 The answer in one line

Let P be the probability of reaching the target first. The game ends in one of two places: $+A$ with probability P , or $-B$ with probability $1 - P$. Every trade is fair, so by Section 2.2 the expected final result must be zero, no matter how you traded:

GAMBLER'S RUIN, EXACT

$$P \times A - (1 - P) \times B = 0 \Rightarrow P = B \div (A + B)$$

For FTMO Phase 1, $A = B = \$10,000$, so $P = 10,000 \div 20,000 = \mathbf{50\%}$. For Phase 2, $A = \$5,000$ and $B = \$10,000$, so $P = 10,000 \div 15,000 = \mathbf{66.7\%}$.

3.2 Checking it by hand

Take a tiny version: steps of \$1, target +2, floor -2. From 0 you need two net wins before two net losses. Call P_x the chance of passing from x . Then $P_2 = 1$, $P_{-2} = 0$, and every middle point is the average of its neighbours: $P_x = \frac{1}{2}P_{x+1} + \frac{1}{2}P_{x-1}$. The only numbers that are "the average of their neighbours" lie on a straight line, so $P_x = (x + 2) \div 4$ and $P_0 = \frac{1}{2}$, exactly as the formula says.

3.3 The value of the phase is a straight line

The same argument works from any balance x between the floor and the target:

PASS PROBABILITY FROM BALANCE x

$$P(x) = (x + B) \div (A + B) \quad (x \text{ measured from the starting balance})$$

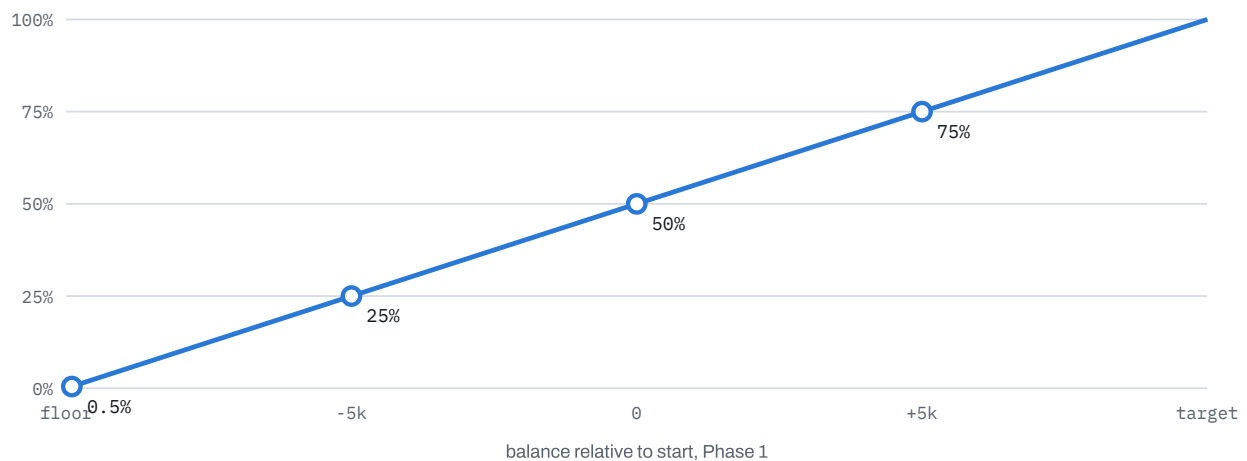


Figure 3.1 · Chance of passing Phase 1 from each balance. It is a straight line from 0 at the floor to 1 at the target, whatever the sizing.

At $-\$9,900$ in Phase 1, with only $\$100$ left above the floor, your chance is $100 \div 20,000 = 0.5\%$. You can only risk $\$100$ there, and the formula already accounts for that: it is the room left above the floor that sets the probability.

3.4 What does not change the answer

Look at what the formula does not contain: no bet size, no reward-to-risk ratio, no number of trades, no volatility. **As long as every trade is fair and the account ends exactly on the target or exactly on the floor, the pass probability is $B \div (A + B)$.** Sizing up after losses, sizing down near the floor, 1 : 1 versus 1 : 3: none of it moves the number. Sizing only changes how many trades it takes, and Chapter 7 shows that the number of trades is what you pay for in costs.

This also means the earlier documents' central claim, that the challenge pays off because "variance is rewarded" (Jensen's inequality), is the wrong explanation. With no time limit, more variance does not raise the pass probability at all. Variance only helps when there is a deadline.

3.5 What does change it: overshoot

The formula assumes the account lands exactly on a barrier. If your last winning trade carries you *past* the target, the extra profit is wasted, and the pass probability falls. If your last losing trade carries you *past* the floor (a price gap through your stop), the firm absorbs the extra loss, and the pass probability rises.

GAMBLER'S RUIN WITH OVERSHOOT

$$P = (B + O_{\text{floor}}) \div (A + O_{\text{target}} + B)$$

Example. The earlier documents traded a fixed $\pm\$4,800$ at 1 : 1. Two wins reach only $+\$9,600$, which is short of the $\$10,000$ target, so a third net win is needed and the account effectively has to reach $+\$14,400$. Then $P \approx 10,000 \div (14,400 + 10,000) = 41\%$ instead of 50%. Choosing a fixed size without looking at the target costs nine percentage points.

RULE FROM CHAPTER 3

Size every trade so that a win lands exactly on the target and a loss lands no lower than the floor. Under that rule the pass probability is fixed at $B \div (A + B)$, and the only thing left to optimise is cost.

The challenge, step by step

The cheapest way to land exactly on a barrier is to use as few trades as possible. Within FTMO's \$5,000 daily loss limit that means risking up to \$5,000 per trade and aiming the take-profit straight at the target. Mathematicians call this **bold play**. Here is the complete tree.

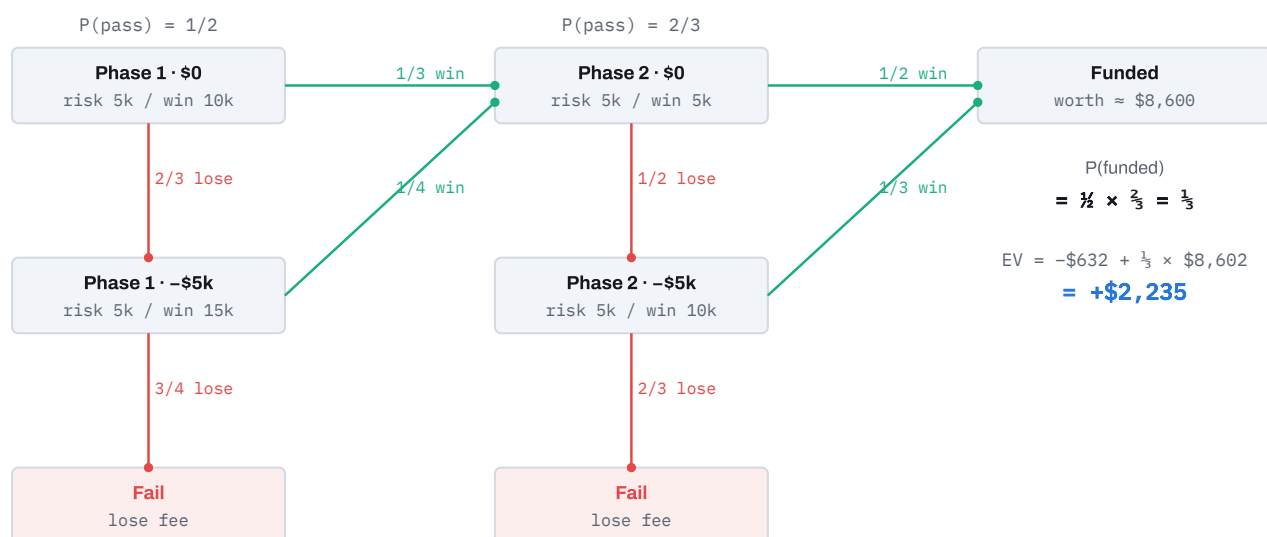


Figure 4.1 · Bold play through both phases. Each trade risks the daily limit and aims exactly at the target.

4.1 Phase 1

Where you are	Trade	Win chance	If it wins	If it loses
Day 1, at \$0	Risk \$5,000, target \$10,000 (1 : 2)	1/3	Pass	Balance -\$5,000
Day 2, at -\$5,000	Risk \$5,000, target \$15,000 (1 : 3)	1/4	Pass	Floor: fail

$$P(\text{pass Phase 1}) = 1/3 + (2/3) \times (1/4) = 1/3 + 1/6 = 1/2$$

Check it with plain 1 : 1 trades of \$5,000 instead. Two wins in a row pass ($1/4$). Two losses in a row fail ($1/4$). One of each brings you back to \$0 ($1/2$), where you start again. So $P = 1/4 + 1/2P$, which gives $P = 1/2$. It is the same answer, as Chapter 3 promised. Bold play just gets there in at most two trades.

4.2 Phase 2

Where you are	Trade	Win chance	If it wins	If it loses
Day 1, at \$0	Risk \$5,000, target \$5,000 (1 : 1)	1/2	Pass	Balance -\$5,000
Day 2, at -\$5,000	Risk \$5,000, target \$10,000 (1 : 2)	1/3	Pass	Floor: fail

$$P(\text{pass Phase 2}) = 1/2 + (1/2) \times (1/3) = 2/3 \quad P(\text{funded}) = 1/2 \times 2/3 = 1/3$$

4.3 Details the tree hides

- **Minimum trading days.** If you pass on day 1 or 2, you still need 4 trading days. Place a tiny trade (for example 0.01 lots with a 5-pip stop) on the remaining days. It changes nothing measurable.
- **The daily limit includes open losses.** Keep each stop a little under \$5,000 (the real-data test used \$4,850) so spread and slippage cannot breach the limit.
- **Phases are independent.** Phase 2 starts again from \$100,000, so its 2/3 does not depend on how Phase 1 went.
- **This is the theoretical optimum, not the Part 2 plan.** Risking the full daily limit on one trade aimed at the target is what FTMO's conduct rules call overexposure or a one-sided bet (Chapter 17). Part 2 keeps risk at 1.5% per trade and gets its speed from the instrument and the stop size instead (Chapters 8–10).

What a funded account is worth

Once funded, there is no target. You trade, withdraw profits every 14 days, keep 80%, and the account continues until equity hits the \$90,000 floor. How much do you expect to collect in total?

5.1 An accounting identity

Follow the money. Every dollar withdrawn from the account came either from trading profit or from the balance going down. Over the whole life of the account:

FUNDED-ACCOUNT IDENTITY (ALWAYS TRUE)

$$Total\ withdrawn = Total\ trading\ profit + (Starting\ balance - Final\ balance)$$

The account ends when the balance reaches the floor, so $Starting - Final = \$10,000$. With zero skill, total trading profit is a sum of fair bets, whose expected value is zero (Section 2.2; the stopping conditions hold because the account is reset to \$100,000 at every payout, which guarantees it ends in finite expected time). Taking expectations:

EXPECTED PAYOUT OF A FUNDED ACCOUNT

$$E[total\ withdrawn] = 0 + \$10,000 = \$10,000 \Rightarrow \text{you receive } 80\% \times \$10,000 = \$8,000 \text{ (minus costs)}$$

In words: **the firm's expected payout equals the loss allowance it gives you.** You keep 80% of every dollar you withdraw, and the firm pays every dollar of loss down to the floor. In a fair game, the dollars won balance the dollars lost, and the losses stop at exactly \$10,000. This is the true source of the option's value. It does not depend on how you trade.

5.2 Simulated check: trading style does not matter

Funded-account trading style	Avg paid, no costs	Avg paid, 1.4% costs	Chance of any payout
Bold: risk \$5k, aim +\$500 first, then +\$5k cycles	\$8,779 ± 137	\$8,340	95%
1% risk, 1 : 1, every day	\$8,579 ± 136	\$7,080	79%
5% risk, 1 : 2, every day	\$8,171 ± 241	\$7,541	27%

20,000 simulated funded accounts per row. Each figure is \$8,000 plus the refunded fee times the chance of at least one payout (the refund only arrives with a first payout). Costs reduce the payout most for the style that trades most.

5.3 Why the earlier "expected maximum = \$10,000" claim is false

The earlier documents argued that a fair walk with a floor \$10,000 below reaches an expected maximum of \$10,000. The chance that it ever climbs m dollars before the floor is $10,000 \div (10,000 + m)$, which falls so slowly that the expected maximum is *infinite*. The correct reason the payout

averages \$10,000 is the identity in 5.1, which depends on withdrawing profits. It also shows that their simulated averages of \$10,271 (which would mean \$12,839 withdrawn) and $13.6\% \times \$22,000$ (which would mean \$8,985 to you per funded account) are impossible with zero skill.

5.4 The refund and the first payout

The €540 fee comes back with your first payout, so it pays to make the first payout very likely. Aim first for a small profit h . The chance of reaching $+h$ before the floor is $10,000 \div (10,000 + h)$. With $h = \$500$ that is 95.2%. Once you reach $+\$500$, stop trading until the payout date, collect \$400 plus the refund, then continue normally. The refund adds about $0.95 \times \$632 \approx \textbf{\$600}$ to the funded value, for a total of about **\$8,600**.

Putting it together

VALUE OF ONE ATTEMPT

$$EV = -\text{Fee} + P(\text{pass 1}) \times P(\text{pass 2}) \times \text{Funded value}$$

$$= -\$632 + \frac{1}{2} \times \frac{2}{3} \times \$8,602 = -\$632 + \$2,867 = +\$2,235$$

6.1 Every possible outcome of one attempt

With bold play in the funded account, each payout cycle after the first pays \$4,000 with probability 2/3 and ends the account with probability 1/3 (the same tree as Phase 2). That makes the full distribution exact:

Outcome	Probability	Net result
Fail Phase 1	50.0%	-\$632
Pass Phase 1, fail Phase 2	16.7%	-\$632
Funded, but bust before the first payout	1.6%	-\$632
First payout (\$400 + refund), then bust	10.6%	+\$400
... plus one \$4,000 cycle	7.1%	+\$4,400
... plus two cycles	4.7%	+\$8,400
... plus three cycles	3.1%	+\$12,400
... plus four or more	6.3%	+\$16,400 and up
Expected value	100%	+\$2,235



Figure 6.1 · One FTMO 100K attempt under bold play, no costs. The expected value is positive, but the most likely single outcome is losing the fee.

The EV is large, but the typical outcome is a loss: 68% of attempts lose the whole fee. The value sits in a long right tail. That shape is why Chapter 12 (bankroll) matters as much as the EV itself.

6.2 If it is this good, why does the firm survive?

On a perfect zero-skill trader, FTMO expects to pay out about \$2,870 for every \$632 fee. Firms survive for three reasons.

- **Most customers are far worse than random.** Industry estimates put real Phase 1 pass rates at 10–15%, against 46–50% for a low-cost coin flip. The difference is mostly trading costs from many small trades with tight stops (Chapter 7), plus abandoning live accounts.
- **Rules remove convexity where it is cheap to remove:** trailing drawdowns, consistency rules, payout caps (Chapter 11).
- **Payouts are discretionary**, and the conduct rules target exactly the fastest version of the strategy (Chapter 16).

Trading costs

Every trade pays the **spread** (the gap between buying and selling price), a **commission**, and sometimes **slippage** (being filled worse than your stop price). Costs are the only thing in this model that turns fair bets into losing ones.

7.1 Measuring cost per trade

For EURUSD on FTMO, a realistic all-in cost is about 0.75 pip per round trip: roughly 0.15 pip of raw spread, 0.5 pip of commission (about \$5 per standard lot) and 0.1 pip of average slippage. What matters is the cost *relative to the stop*. We call this ratio κ (kappa):

COST RATIO

$$\kappa = \text{cost in pips} \div \text{stop distance in pips} \quad \text{e.g. } 0.75 \div 55 \approx 1.4\%$$

A trade risking \$1,000 with a 55-pip stop costs about \$14. The same \$1,000 risk with a 10-pip stop needs 5.5 times the position size, so it costs about \$75 ($\kappa = 7.5\%$).

7.2 Costs as a drift

A cost of c dollars per trade turns the fair bet into one with $EV = -c$. The pass formula becomes, approximately:

PASS PROBABILITY WITH COSTS

$$P \approx (B - \text{expected total cost}) \div (A + B)$$

7.3 Why the number of trades is what you pay for

With fair trades of size L (risk L , target L), the expected number of trades to finish a phase is $A \times B \div L^2$. Each costs about $\kappa \times L$, so:

EXPECTED TOTAL COST OF A PHASE

$$\text{Cost} \approx \kappa \times L \times (A \times B \div L^2) = \kappa \times A \times B \div L$$

Phase 1 with $\kappa = 1.4\%$	Risk per trade L	Expected trades	Expected cost	P(pass)
Bold play (Chapter 4)	\$5,000	≈ 1.7	$\approx \$180$	48.9%
Slow 1% plan (version 1)	\$1,000	≈ 100	$\approx \$1,400$	$\approx 44\text{--}45\%$
Scalper, 10-pip stops ($\kappa = 7.5\%$)	\$500	≈ 400	$\approx \$15,000$	$\approx 0\%$

The scalper's expected costs exceed the whole loss allowance. This one line explains most of the gap between the textbook 50% and the industry's 10–15%.

7.4 How to keep costs low

- **Wide stops are cheap but slow.** A stop of about one day's range keeps κ near 1–1.5% on EURUSD, but each trade then lasts days. Chapter 11 shows how to trade cost against time.
- **Liquid instruments and hours.** EURUSD during the London and New York sessions has the tightest spreads.
- **Avoid scheduled news.** Rate decisions, US payrolls and CPI cause slippage on stops.
- **Swap.** Holding overnight earns or pays a small interest charge. With ~1–2 day trades it is minor, but check your platform's swap table.

With $\kappa \approx 1.4\%$ applied to every trade, the simulated EV of the bold plan falls from +\$2,272 to **+\$2,081** (100,000 simulated attempts).

Time: how long an attempt takes

Expected value per attempt is only half the story. If one plan earns \$1,400 per attempt and needs 86 weeks, and another earns \$1,400 and needs 3 weeks, the second is worth almost thirty times more per month. This chapter derives how long each phase takes and which choices make it faster.

8.1 How many trades a phase needs

Take fair trades that risk L and aim for $k \times L$ (reward-to-risk 1 : k). Each trade adds a random amount with mean zero and variance $k \times L^2$. A second fair-game identity (Wald's) says the expected squared final result equals the expected number of trades times the variance per trade. The final result is $+A$ with probability $B \div (A + B)$ and $-B$ otherwise, so its expected square is $A \times B$.

EXPECTED NUMBER OF TRADES IN A PHASE

$$N = A \times B \div (k \times L^2)$$

FTMO Phase 1 ($A = B = \$10,000$) with 1% risk and 1 : 1 needs about 100 trades. With 1.5% risk and 1 : 3 it needs about $10,000 \times 10,000 \div (3 \times 1,500^2) \approx 15$ trades.

8.2 How long one trade takes

A bracket closes when price moves a distance s against you or $k \times s$ in your favour. If the price moves with volatility σ per hour (its typical one-hour move), the same identity applied to price gives:

EXPECTED DURATION OF ONE BRACKET

$$T_{trade} \approx k \times s^2 \div \sigma^2 \quad \text{hours}$$

A stop of one hourly move ($s = \sigma$) at 1 : 1 takes about one active hour. A stop of three hourly moves takes about nine.

8.3 Time and cost of a whole phase

Multiply the two. The reward-to-risk ratio k cancels:

PHASE TIME AND PHASE COST

$$Time \approx A \times B \times s^2 \div (L^2 \times \sigma^2) \quad Cost \approx A \times B \times c \div (k \times L \times s)$$

Here c is the round-trip cost as a fraction of price. These two lines contain every lever:

Lever	Effect on time	Effect on cost	Limit
Risk per trade L	Falls with L^2 : 1.5% is 2.25× faster than 1%	Falls with L	Firm guidance: FTMO suggests 1–1.5%
Stop distance s	Rises with s^2	Falls with s	The trade-off you optimise
Reward-to-risk k	No effect	Falls with k	Overshoot near the target; real-data drift at far targets
Instrument	Sets the price of speed: cost c against movement σ		Chapter 9
Leverage	None, unless it forces a wider stop than you want (Section 9.3)		Rarely binds

8.4 The speed–cost trade-off

A tighter stop finishes the phase sooner but costs more per dollar risked. If the expected value per attempt falls roughly in a straight line with cost, $EV \approx EV_0 - \beta/s$, and time grows like s^2 , then EV per unit time is $(EV_0 - \beta/s) \div s^2$. Setting its derivative to zero gives $s = 1.5 \beta \div EV_0$, where EV is one third of EV_0 .

THE SURPRISING RULE

When time is what matters, the best stop is tight enough that trading costs eat about **two thirds** of the no-cost expected value. Fixed waiting times (minimum days, reviews, the 14-day payout calendar) push the optimum back towards wider stops, because once those waits dominate, more speed buys little. Chapter 10 finds the real optimum by simulation.

8.5 Fixed waits you cannot trade away

- **Minimum trading days:** 4 per phase at FTMO, 3 at FundingPips and The5ers, 5 at FundedNext.
- **Reviews:** about 1 day between phases and 1–3 days for identity checks and the contract before funding.
- **The payout calendar:** FTMO's first payout comes 14 days after your first funded trade, then every 14 days. FundingPips offers weekly payouts at a 60% split. FundedNext's first cycle is 21 days. Crypto firms such as Breakout and HyroTrader pay on demand.

These waits set a floor. Even the fastest pass cannot produce an FTMO payout much sooner than about 25 days after purchase: 4 + 4 minimum trading days, about 4 days of reviews, then 14 days to the first payout date.

Instruments, leverage and platforms

9.1 The one number that ranks instruments

From Section 8.3, for a fixed time budget, the cost you pay is proportional to $c \div \sigma$: the trading cost compared with how far the instrument moves. Over a full trading week this becomes:

INSTRUMENT EFFICIENCY

Efficiency = typical weekly move $\div$ round-trip trading cost (higher = faster for the same cost)

Weekly movement already includes trading hours. An instrument that trades 24/7 gets credit for its weekend movement automatically, so "crypto trades all week" is already counted.

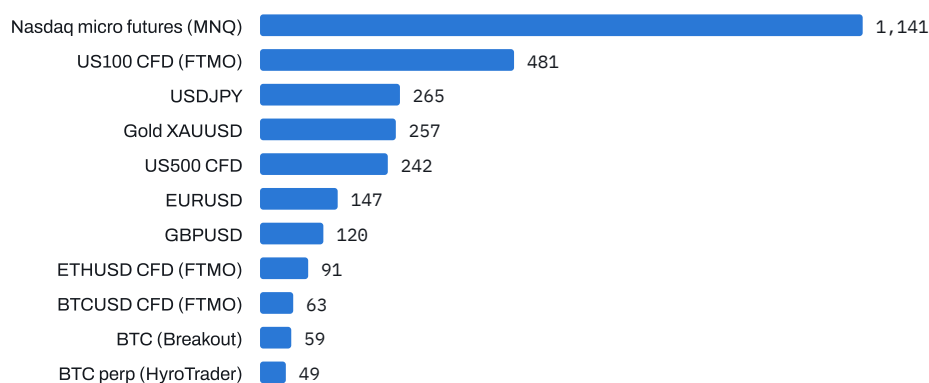


Figure 9.1 · Weekly move divided by round-trip cost. Higher means an instrument can be traded faster for the same cost.

Instrument (platform)	Weekly move	Round-trip cost	Efficiency	Max leverage	Hours/week
Nasdaq 100 micro futures (futures firms)	3.08%	0.0027%	1,141	–	~110
US100 CFD (FTMO, zero commission)	3.08%	0.0064%	481	1:50	~110
USDJPY (FTMO)	1.35%	0.0051%	265	1:100	~118
Gold XAUUSD (FTMO)	2.78%	0.0108%	257	1:30	~110
US500 CFD (FTMO)	2.32%	0.0096%	242	1:50	~110
EURUSD (FTMO)	0.91%	0.0062%	147	1:100	~118
GBPUSD (FTMO)	0.91%	0.0076%	120	1:100	~118
ETHUSD CFD (FTMO, 0.0325%/side commission)	9.52%	0.105%	91	1:3.3	168
BTCUSD CFD (FTMO)	5.89%	0.093%	63	1:3.3	168
BTC (Breakout/Kraken, 0.04%/side)	5.89%	0.10%	59	1:5	168
BTC perp (HyroTrader/Bybit, taker 0.055%/side)	5.89%	0.12%	49	up to 1:100	168

Weekly move: standard deviation of weekly returns, hourly data 2023–26. Costs: published FTMO spreads (US100 1.66 pts, gold \$0.52, EURUSD raw spread plus \$3/lot commission), exchange fees for crypto firms, plus an allowance for slippage. Futures: about \$1.70 per micro contract round trip. Check your own platform: Chapter 18.

9.2 Crypto: trading 24/7 does not help

Bitcoin moves about six times as much as EURUSD in a week, partly because it trades on weekends. But on prop platforms it costs fifteen to twenty times as much per trade, because crypto carries percentage commissions (0.0325% per side at FTMO, 0.04% at Breakout, 0.055% taker at Bybit). Its efficiency ends up between a half and a tenth of the alternatives. Chapter 10 confirms it: the best crypto set-up found earns about a fifth of the Nasdaq plan per month.

9.3 What leverage actually does

Leverage does not make trades resolve faster. Time depends on how far price must travel (the stop distance) compared with how fast it moves. Leverage only limits position size, and so sets the *tightest* stop you can use for a given risk:

TIGHTEST STOP ALLOWED BY LEVERAGE λ

$$s_{min} = \text{risk per trade} \div (\lambda \times \text{account size}) \quad 1.5\% \text{ risk at } 1:50 \rightarrow 0.03\%; \text{ at } 1:3.3 \rightarrow 0.45\%$$

For indices, metals and currencies the limit is far below any sensible stop. For crypto at FTMO (1:3.3), 0.45% is just above one hourly Bitcoin move, so leverage would block the fastest crypto stops. Costs make those stops unattractive anyway.

9.4 Overnight financing

Positions held through the daily rollover pay (or occasionally earn) financing on their full size. With tight stops the position is large, so even one night can cost several percent of the risk on index and gold CFDs. Fast plans close most trades within hours, which keeps this small. The simulations charge it on every rollover crossed.

9.5 Futures

Futures are the cheapest instrument of all, but futures prop firms use trailing drawdowns, small accounts (\$2,000 allowance on 50K), payout ladders and consistency rules (Chapter 11). Their value per account is small, though attempts are quick and some firms allow many accounts at once.

Maximising expected value per month

10.1 Method

For each instrument we measured, on real hourly data, how long random-direction brackets of each size actually take (including waiting for trading hours and weekends) and how often they cross the rollover. Those measured durations then drive a full simulation of each firm's contract with calendar time:

- Daily loss limits, minimum days and reviews.
- Payout calendars and refunds.
- A daily guard that stops trading before the daily limit can be breached.

Every set-up was simulated 1,200–4,000 times. The trades are assumed to have **no edge**: the small win-rate deviations seen in the data were treated as noise. The result is *expected value per month per account slot* = expected value per attempt ÷ average length of an attempt.

10.2 Stop size

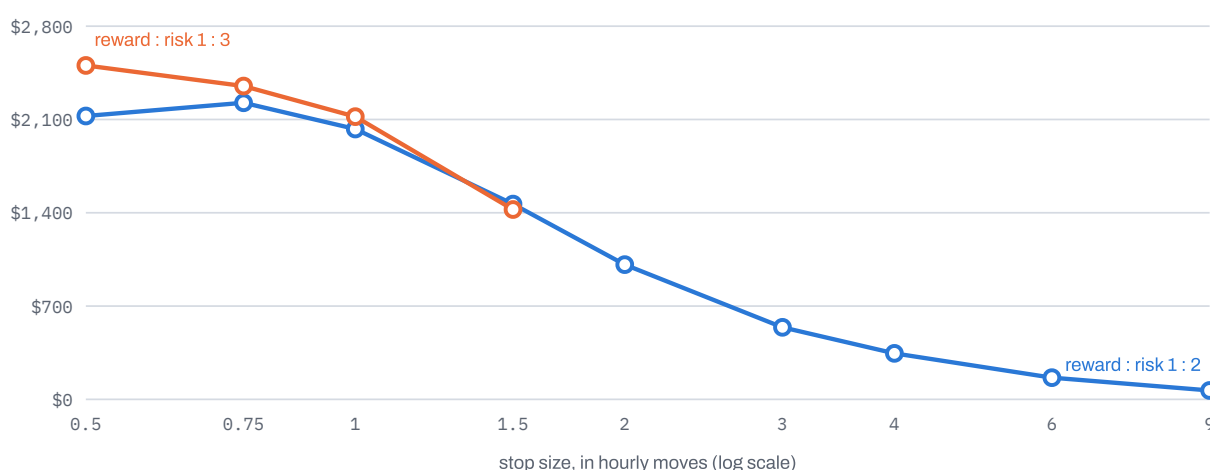


Figure 10.1 · EV per month per slot against stop size. FTMO 2-Step, US100, 1.5% risk, zero edge. The best stops are short.

The best stop is short: about **0.5–1 hourly move**, which is 40–85 Nasdaq points. At 0.75 hourly moves, costs take roughly 40% of the no-cost value, which matches the trade-off of Section 8.4 once the fixed payout waits are included. Very wide stops (the earlier plan used about six hourly moves on EURUSD) are thirty times slower.

10.3 Reward-to-risk, risk per trade and payout policy

FTMO 2-Step, US100	EV per attempt	Days per attempt	EV per month
Stop 1 hourly move, 1 : 1, risk 1.5%	+\$880	22	\$1,236
Stop 1 hourly move, 1 : 2, risk 1.5%	+\$1,469	22	\$2,029
Stop 1 hourly move, 1 : 3, risk 1.5%	+\$1,402	20	\$2,122

FTMO 2-Step, US100	EV per attempt	Days per attempt	EV per month
Stop 0.75 hourly moves, 1 : 3, risk 1.0%	+\$1,234	25	\$1,503
Stop 0.75 hourly moves, 1 : 3, risk 1.5%	+\$1,355	18	\$2,351
Same, funded target +\$3,000 per cycle instead of +\$10,000	+\$1,526	25	\$1,892

- **Reward-to-risk 1 : 2 or 1 : 3** beats 1 : 1 by a wide margin. As Section 8.3 predicts, it costs no time and cuts the number of trades.
- **1.5% risk** beats 1%, also as predicted (time falls with L^2). Both are inside FTMO's 1–1.5% guidance; this plan does not go above it.
- **Funded payout policy.** Aim for a large profit per 14-day cycle (+\$10,000) rather than a small one. Fewer cycles mean the account resolves sooner. The first cycle still aims for +\$1,000 to secure the fee refund.

10.4 Instrument

FTMO 2-Step, best set-up per instrument	EV per month per slot
US100 (Nasdaq CFD)	\$2,350–2,500
Gold (XAUUSD)	\$2,071
USDJPY	\$1,814
US500	\$1,467
EURUSD	\$1,179
GBPUSD	\$781
ETHUSD CFD	\$299
BTCUSD CFD	\$83

10.5 Firm

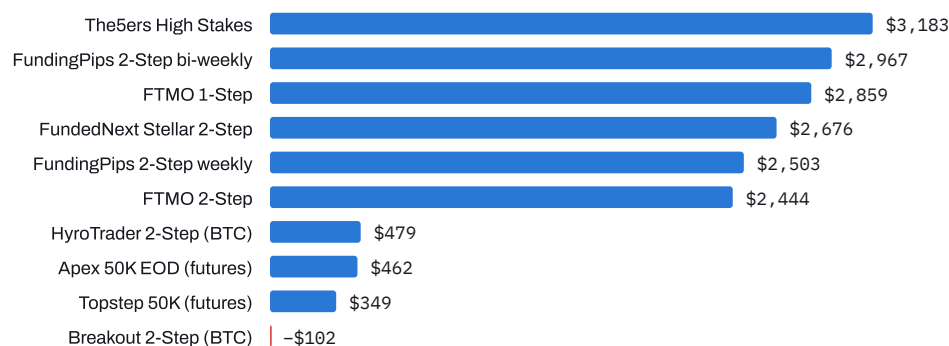


Figure 10.2 · EV per month per account slot, best set-up found for each programme (zero edge, payouts honoured).

Firm and programme (100K, US100 plan)	EV per attempt	Days per attempt	EV per month	Median days to first payout
The5ers High Stakes	+\$1,869	18	\$3,183	23

Firm and programme (100K, US100 plan)	EV per attempt	Days per attempt	EV per month	Median days to first payout
FundingPips 2-Step, bi-weekly 80%	+\$1,743	18	\$2,967	23
FTMO 1-Step	+\$1,755	19	\$2,859	23
FundedNext Stellar 2-Step	+\$1,866	21	\$2,676	34
FundingPips 2-Step, weekly 60%	+\$1,171	14	\$2,503	16
FTMO 2-Step	+\$1,429	18	\$2,444	27
Apex 50K EOD (futures, MNQ, \$500 risk)	+\$148	10	\$462	13
HyroTrader 2-Step (BTC, 3% risk)	+\$571	36	\$479	28
Topstep 50K (futures, MNQ, \$500 risk)	+\$76	7	\$349	12
Breakout 2-Step (BTC)	-\$250	75	-\$102	78

±\$170–210 on EV per attempt for the CFD firms (4,000 simulations each). The same Nasdaq costs were assumed at every CFD firm; their real spreads may differ. Futures values are per 50K account.

The CFD firms with an 8% Phase 1 target (The5ers, FundingPips) come out ahead of FTMO 2-Step's 10%. The FTMO 1-Step's 90% split and resetting floor also beat it. The weekly 60% payout option pays sooner but less. The crypto firms and Breakout's 6% drawdown with a 10% Phase 2 target are poor contracts.

10.6 Check on real prices

We re-ran the winning FTMO set-up on the actual 2024–26 Nasdaq price path, with every bracket resolved on real bars:

Real-path test, FTMO 2-Step (1,500 attempts each)	EV per attempt	Days	EV per month
US100, stop 0.75 hourly moves, 1 : 3, 1.5% risk	+\$2,076 ± 372	19	\$3,281
Same, trading costs × 1.5	+\$1,596 ± 322	18	\$2,688
US100, stop 1 hourly move, 1 : 2	+\$1,675 ± 355	22	\$2,289
EURUSD, stop 1 hourly move, 1 : 3	+\$1,214 ± 282	18	\$2,004

Real prices came out above the zero-edge model. Part of that is favourable noise: in this sample, far targets were hit slightly more often than fair odds. Plan with the zero-edge numbers, about **\$2,400 per month per FTMO 2-Step slot**.

10.7 What one account slot looks like over a year

One FTMO 100K slot, fast plan, rebuying after each attempt	1 month	3 months	6 months	12 months
Chance of being ahead	5%	36%	69%	88%
Average result	-\$1,757	+\$1,088	+\$7,781	+\$23,110
Median result	-\$1,896	-\$1,560	+\$5,344	+\$20,584

One FTMO 100K slot, fast plan, rebuying after each attempt	1 month	3 months	6 months	12 months
Bad case (10th percentile)	-\$3,160	-\$5,056	-\$6,616	-\$1,272
Good case (90th percentile)	-\$632	+\$13,008	+\$23,872	+\$49,648

2,000 simulated years. Fees are counted when paid; payouts are counted at the end of each attempt (slightly pessimistic timing). About 1.6 attempts per month per slot, so roughly \$1,000 a month in fees.

Other firms and other rule types

Every challenge can be valued with the same two tools: a pass probability for each phase, and the identity for the funded account. What changes between firms is the shape of the floor and the payout rules.

11.1 Static floor

FTMO 2-Step and most forex/CFD 2-Steps work as in Chapters 3–5: $P = B \div (A + B)$ per phase, funded value $\approx \text{split} \times B$.

11.2 End-of-day (EOD) trailing drawdown

The floor rises whenever a day closes at a new high, and stays there. If you can pass in a single day, the floor never moves and you get the static answer. Firms add **consistency rules** ("your best day may not exceed X% of total profit") to force several profitable days, each of which lifts the floor.

11.3 Intraday trailing drawdown

The floor follows your highest *live equity*, including unrealised profit. With prices that move continuously, the best possible chance of reaching A before a drawdown of D from the peak is:

INTRADAY TRAILING, ANY STRATEGY

$P = e^{-A/D}$ (for driftless prices, the peak reached before a drawdown of D is exponentially distributed with mean D)

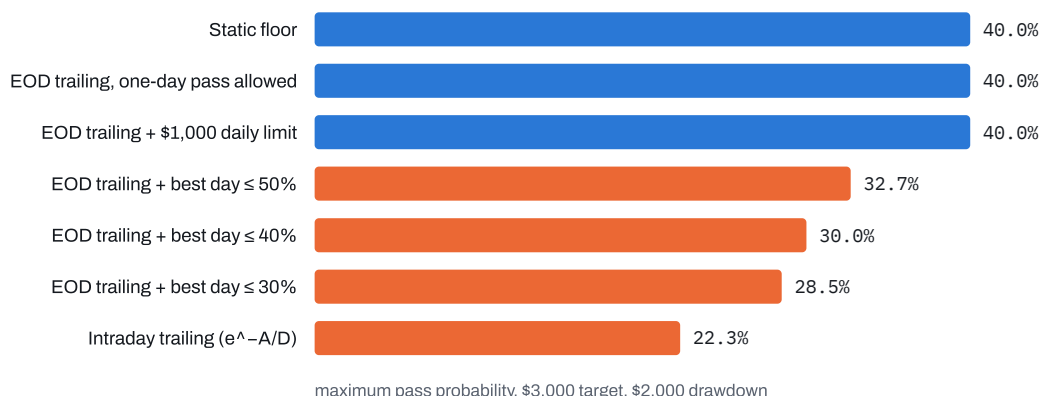


Figure 11.1 · How each rule type changes the best achievable pass probability (dynamic programming; intraday is the continuous-price bound).

11.4 Funded accounts with locks and caps

Futures firms typically start the funded floor at the same trailing distance, then "lock" it at the starting balance plus about \$100 once you are far enough ahead. They also cap payouts (for example Apex closes the account after six payouts). The identity still holds, so the funded value is

split $\times$ (expected start minus final balance). Locks and caps reduce it, typically to around \$1,500 on a \$2,000 allowance, and to about \$700 when the trail is intraday.

11.5 The ranking

We valued 37 account types at 16 firms the same way: zero skill, best sizing for each rule set, 1% trading costs, payouts honoured. The full table is in Appendix B.

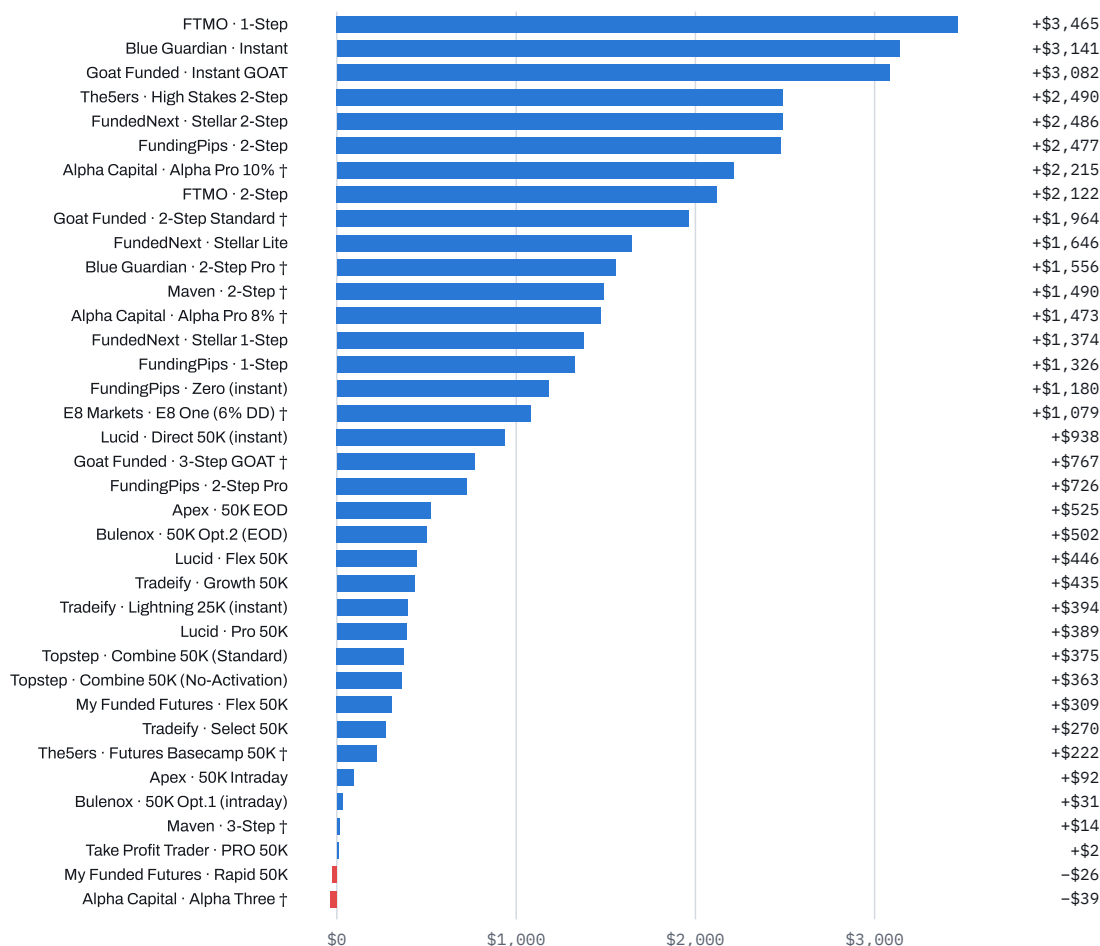


Figure 11.2 · Expected value per attempt, zero skill, 1% costs, payouts honoured. † rule set partly inferred.

- **Static 10% 2-Steps** (FundedNext, FundingPips, The5ers, FTMO): +\$2,000 to +\$2,500 per attempt.
- **FTMO 1-Step** ranks first (+\$3,465): its trailing floor resets with each payout and the split is 90%.
- **Futures evaluations** are cheap and return the most per dollar of fee, but each is worth only \$300–\$550.
- **Intraday trailing** accounts and **3-step** programmes are worth close to nothing, or less.
- **Instant-funding** values are upper estimates: their payout caps and consistency rules were not fully modelled.

Variance, bankroll and Kelly

A positive EV only shows up after many attempts. Because most attempts lose the fee and a few pay a lot, you need enough money to survive the losing runs.

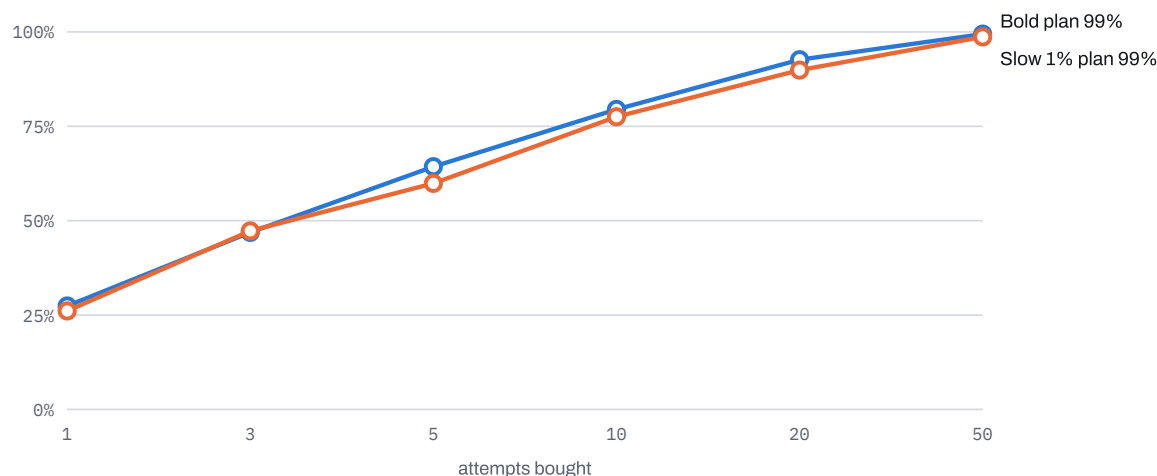


Figure 12.1 · Chance of being ahead after buying n FTMO 100K attempts (real EURUSD data, bootstrap).

Attempts bought	1	3	5	10	20	50
Chance of being ahead, bold plan	27%	47%	64%	79%	93%	99%
Chance of being ahead, slow 1% plan	26%	47%	60%	78%	90%	99%

Bootstrap from 6,000 (bold) and 3,000 (slow 1% plan) simulated attempts on real EURUSD data. The fast plan of Part 2 is shown month by month in Section 10.7.

12.1 Risk of ruin

If you start with a fixed amount and buy attempts until you either run out of fees or complete 100 attempts, the chance of running out (bold plan, real data) is 53% with 3 fees (\$1,896), 35% with 5 fees (\$3,160), 11% with 10 fees (\$6,320) and 1.2% with 20 fees (\$12,640). The slow 1% plan is riskier per attempt, because more of its attempts lose: 22% ruin with 10 fees and 5% with 20.

12.2 The Kelly criterion, done correctly

The Kelly criterion picks the bet size that makes your wealth grow fastest over time. For a bet with mean gain μ and variance σ^2 per unit staked, the growth-optimal stake is roughly $\mu \div \sigma^2$ of your wealth. For a fixed-size bet such as one challenge, this inverts: the bankroll at which buying one attempt is growth-optimal is about $\sigma^2 \div \mu$.

BANKROLL FOR ONE ATTEMPT AT FULL KELLY

$W \approx \sigma^2 \div \mu$ exact log-growth on the real-data outcomes: $\approx \$4,100$ (bold) and $\approx \$6,000$ (slow 1% plan)

The earlier documents computed $\mu \div \sigma^2 = 1.4 \times 10^{-5}$, treated it as a fraction of wealth, and concluded you need \$40 million. The units are wrong: $\mu \div \sigma^2$ is "per dollar", not a percentage. Half-Kelly (about \$8,000–12,000) is a sensible minimum for someone who wants smaller swings.

Hedging

The idea is to take opposite positions in two accounts, at the same firm, at two firms, or against a personal brokerage account, so that one account's loss is the other's gain.

13.1 Hedging cannot create value

Expected values add (Section 2.1). The expected total of several accounts is the sum of their individual EVs, however their results are linked. If each account is worth +\$2,235, a hedged pair is worth exactly +\$4,470. If each were worth -\$100, hedging would lock in -\$200. A hedge changes only the *spread* of outcomes.

13.2 The values are straight lines, so a hedge can be exact

With a static floor, the value of each stage is a straight line in its own balance (Section 3.3):

Stage (no costs)	Value at start	Value per \$1 of balance (slope)
Funded account	\$8,602	0.80
Phase 2	\$5,735	$8,602 \div 15,000 = 0.573$
Phase 1	\$2,867	$5,735 \div 20,000 = 0.287$

Holding an opposite position equal to the slope makes the total value constant. For example, two Phase 1 accounts with opposite positions (equal target and floor distances) always produce exactly one pass, and a personal account holding $0.287\times$ the opposite exposure locks in \$2,867 – \$632 per attempt. Mathematically, hedging turns the lottery of Chapter 6 into a near-certain cash flow.

13.3 Why it does not work in practice

- **It is prohibited.** FTMO's forbidden-practices page bans opposite positions across accounts, explicitly including "accounts held with various operators/providers", with forfeiture of rewards and termination of all agreements. Most firms have equivalent clauses.
- **It cannot protect against a refused payout.** Against your own brokerage account, the paths where the prop account wins are exactly the paths where your real money lost. If that payout is refused, the loss is real, up to \$8,000 per funded account, where the unhedged loss would only have been the fee.

Hedging is therefore covered here only to explain the mathematics. It is not part of the execution plan.

Testing it on real market data

14.1 Method

Data: hourly EURUSD bars, 18 December 2023 to 2 October 2026 (730 trading days). Each simulated attempt starts on a random date and opens each trade at a random weekday hour between 07:00 and 16:00 UTC, in a random direction. Brackets resolve on real highs and lows. When one hourly bar touches both stop and target, a coin flip decides (this cannot bias the result). Costs are 0.75 pip per round trip. FTMO's daily and maximum loss limits, minimum days, 14-day payout cycles, 80% split and refund are all applied. Funded accounts run until they hit the floor. When the data runs out it wraps to the start.

14.2 Results

Strategy	EV per attempt	P(pass 1)	P(funded)	P(profit)	Avg length
Bold play (Chapter 4), 6,000 attempts	+\$1,764 ± 161	46.4%	29.5%	28.0%	≈ 6 weeks
Slow 1% plan (version 1): 1% risk, 1 : 1, 3,000 attempts	+\$1,398 ± 193	45.0%	27.2%	26.1%	≈ 86 weeks
Same with 1 : 2 targets	+\$1,368 ± 209	38.2%	23.2%	22.2%	≈ 44 weeks
Earlier PDFs' protocol (±\$4,800, 1 : 1, quit after 2 losses, daily flatten)	-\$173 ± 79	14.6%	8.2%	3.5%	–

± values are 95% confidence ranges. "Avg length" counts market time from purchase to the end of the attempt (failure, or the funded account hitting its floor).

The real-data figures sit a little below the cost-only model (+\$2,081 for bold play). The gap comes from the safety buffer kept above the floor, hourly resolution, and the mild mean reversion seen in Section 2.4. The sign and size are confirmed. The fast plan of Part 2 was tested the same way in Section 10.6.

14.3 Why the earlier protocol loses

Earlier protocol variant	EV per attempt	P(funded)
As written: quit Phase 1 after 2 full losses, flatten before New York close	-\$70 ± 90	8.8%
Quit rule kept, no daily flatten	+\$404 ± 165	14.8%
No quit rule, daily flatten kept	+\$884 ± 152	22.1%
Neither	+\$672 ± 178	19.9%

The quit rule is the main damage. A live account is always worth $(x + B) \div (A + B)$ of the next stage's value (Section 3.3), so abandoning it throws that value away. After a win-win-loss-loss sequence, for instance, you are back at \$0 with a full 50% chance, and the rule tells you to quit. The fixed ±\$4,800 size adds the overshoot loss of Section 3.5.

Errors in the earlier "Convex Edge" documents

For readers coming from the earlier "FTMO Convex-EV" / "Convex Edge" PDFs, this is what changes and why.

Earlier claim	Correct statement	Status
The edge comes from variance via Jensen's inequality; EV rises with σ^2 .	With no deadline, the pass probability is $B/(A+B)$ for any σ . The edge is the loss allowance (Chapter 5).	wrong mechanism
A fair walk's expected maximum before the floor equals the floor distance.	It is infinite. The funded value follows from the withdrawal identity.	false
Funded payout \$10,271 at 80% split; EV +\$3,223 / +\$2,502.	Implies \$12,839 withdrawn against a \$10,000 allowance, which is impossible. The EV formula also refunded the fee to every funded account, including those that never got paid.	impossible
13.6% $\times$ \$22,000 naive EV.	\$8,985 per funded account, above the \$8,000 ceiling.	impossible
1:1 is the only RR that makes a symmetric walk.	Every fair bracket is a martingale. RR matters only through overshoot.	false
Fixed $\pm$ \$4,800 trades at 1:1.	Overshoots the target and cuts Phase 1 from 50% to 41%.	costly
A constant $\sim$ \$30 cost per trade regardless of size creates a "trap" near the floor.	Costs scale with lot size. With proportional costs there is no trap, and dynamic sizing does not change the pass probability.	model bug
Effective win rate of 48.5% (spread asymmetry plus mean reversion).	Measured 49.7–50.4% for symmetric brackets. The spread asymmetry is the spread cost, so it was counted twice.	not in data
Quit Phase 1 after two consecutive full losses.	Throws away live value. On real data, removing it moves the protocol from $-\$70$ to $+\$884$.	main loss
Kelly implies a \$40M bankroll.	Units error. About \$4,100 for bold play, \$6,000 for the Part 2 plan.	10,000 $\times$ off
RR table shows 1:1.5 as best.	The table's own maximum was 1:0.5; the differences are simulation noise.	noise
Use 1:2 on the funded account for more EV.	Funded value is $\text{split} \times B$ for any RR.	irrelevant
Abandoned accounts free up allocation.	They remain open and count toward the cap.	false
"Defensibility": vary lots, rotate sessions, add decoy trades, stagger purchases.	These disguise a pattern the terms prohibit. If discovered, they justify forfeiture. Part 2 follows the rules instead.	removed
\$4,600–5,000 per month from four accounts.	Derived from wrong per-attempt maths with a losing protocol. A corrected fast plan inside the risk guidance (Chapter 13) reaches a similar order, about \$2,400 per FTMO slot per month in the zero-edge model, if payouts are honoured.	wrong derivation
Zero-skill play is positive EV if payouts are honoured.	Correct, and by more per attempt than the earlier documents said.	correct

What the mathematics cannot tell you

Every number so far assumes the firm pays what it owes. That assumption is the weakest link, and no model can price it.

- **Payouts are discretionary.** Funded accounts are simulated, and "rewards" are paid under terms that let the firm refuse them for practices it considers non-genuine.
- **Conduct rules.** FTMO lists "overleveraging, overexposure, one-sided bets, account rolling" and hedging across accounts as forbidden, and recommends risking 1–1.5% per trade. The bold plan of Chapter 4 matches the prohibited pattern.
- **Firm failure.** About 80–100 prop firms closed in 2024–25. True Forex Funds closed owing about \$1.2 million; The Funded Trader admitted to more than \$2 million in denied payouts; MyForexFunds was shut by a CFTC action in 2023.
- **Rule changes.** Fees, splits and limits change often. Each change moves the numbers in this document.
- **Behaviour.** The maths assumes you follow the plan exactly through long losing runs. Skipping trades, sizing up to "win it back" or quitting live accounts all lower the result.
- **Model limits.** The real-data test covers 2.8 years of one currency pair. A different period could show more or less mean reversion. Costs differ between platforms.

BREAK-EVEN PAYOUT REFUSAL RATE (FTMO 2-STEP, 1% COSTS)

$EV \geq 0$ as long as fewer than about 77% of owed payouts are refused

That looks comfortable, but refusals are not independent coin flips. A refusal usually comes with the account closed and the person barred, which ends all future attempts. The realistic protection is to trade in a way that does not breach the terms at all. That is the purpose of Part 2.

PART 2

Execution

The plan that maximised expected value per month in Chapter 10, written step by step. It stays inside FTMO's published rules and its 1–1.5% risk guidance. FTMO 2-Step 100K is the worked example; Chapter 25 covers other firms.

The plan, and why this one

	Bold plan (Ch. 4)	Slow plan (version 1)	Fast plan (this Part)
Instrument	EURUSD	EURUSD	US100 (Nasdaq CFD)
Risk per trade	Up to \$5,000	\$1,000 (1%)	\$1,500 (1.5%)
Stop	~1 day's move	~6 hourly moves (~55 pips)	0.75 hourly moves (~64 points)
Reward : risk	Aim at target	1 : 1	1 : 3
Trades	One a day	One at a time, next day	One at a time, back to back
EV per attempt (zero edge)		+\$2,081	+\$1,254
Average attempt	~6 weeks	~86 weeks	~18 days
EV per month per slot		≈ \$1,300	≈ \$70
Median time to first payout	~4 weeks	over a year	~27 days
Inside FTMO's risk guidance	No (overexposure, one-sided bets)	Yes	Yes

The fast plan beats even the bold plan per month while risking only 1.5% per trade. It gets its speed from the instrument and the stop size, not from big bets.

READ THIS BEFORE PART 2

- All figures assume the firm pays every payout. Payouts are discretionary. Many short random-direction trades may be judged by a risk team in ways no model can predict.
- About three attempts in four lose the fee. After one month the chance of being ahead on a slot is about 5%; after a year it is about 88% (Section 10.7).
- The trades have no edge. The plan earns only from the contract, never from the market.

Before you start

18.1 Requirements

- ☐ You are an adult (18+); firms verify identity before paying.
- ☐ A bankroll you can lose entirely: about \$7,000–10,000 per account slot you plan to run (Section 10.7's bad case at six months is −\$6,600). Never borrowed money.
- ☐ MetaTrader 5 (or the firm's platform) and either an Expert Advisor (an automated trading program that MT5 runs for you) or the time to place trades by hand (Section 22.3).
- ☐ The firm's current trading objectives, forbidden practices and payout terms, read in full.

18.2 Choose the firm

Per Chapter 10, the best expected value per month comes from static-drawdown 2-Steps with an 8% Phase 1 target (The5ers High Stakes, FundingPips 2-Step) and from FTMO 1-Step. FTMO 2-Step is close behind and has the longest payout record. Avoid intraday trailing drawdowns, 3-step programmes and the crypto programmes.

18.3 Measure your costs (do not skip)

The whole plan rests on the Nasdaq costing about 2 points per round trip, including slippage. On a free demo of your firm's platform:

1. Open the symbol specification for US100 (FTMO calls it US100.cash). Write down the value of one point for one lot (call it V) and the minimum lot size.
2. During 14:00–20:00 UTC, note the spread every few minutes for a day. Average it.
3. Add 0.5–0.6 points for slippage. If the total is above about 3 points, the plan's value per month falls by roughly a third. Re-check Chapter 10, or use gold or USDJPY instead.

18.4 Measure the hourly move

The stop is set in "hourly moves", the typical size of one hour's price change. Over 2024–26 it averaged 0.27% of the US100 price, about 85 points at 31,000. Recompute it every Monday:

HOURLY MOVE (SIMPLE VERSION)

hourly move $\approx$ average of $|close - previous\ close|$ over the last 100 hourly bars $\times 1.25$

The plan on one page

EVERY TRADE

1. **One position at a time** on US100. Open the next trade as soon as the last one closes, inside the trading window.
2. **Trading window:** open new trades Monday to Friday, 01:00–20:00 UTC. No new trades after 20:00 UTC on Friday; close anything still open by 20:30 UTC Friday.
3. **Risk** = the smallest of: \$1,500; (room above the floor – \$100); (\$5,000 – today's loss so far – \$200).
4. **Stop** = $0.75 \times$ hourly move (about 60–65 points).
5. **Target** = $3 \times$ the stop distance, except near a target (rule 7).
6. **Lots** = $\text{risk} \div (\text{stop in points} \times V)$, rounded down.
7. **Near a target:** if $3 \times$ risk would carry you past the phase target or the payout-cycle target, set the take-profit to the remaining distance *plus this trade's cost* ($\text{spread} \times \text{lots} \times V + \5).
8. Attach stop and target on entry; never move them.

EVERY DAY

1. If today's loss would leave less than \$1,700 of the \$5,000 daily limit, reduce the next trade's risk to fit. If less than \$300 would remain, stop until the next FTMO day (midnight Prague time).
2. 15 minutes before a scheduled high-impact US release (CPI, payrolls, the Fed decision), do not open a new trade. On a funded account, close an open trade before the release: FTMO's standard funded accounts restrict opening or closing trades within 2 minutes of high-impact news (check the current rule for your account type).

EVERY ACCOUNT

1. Never abandon a live account (Section 3.3).
2. When a phase target is reached, stop. If minimum days are missing, place one tiny trade (0.01 lot, 5-point stop) per day.
3. Funded, first cycle: trade until +\$1,000, then stop and wait for payout day. Later cycles: trade until +\$10,000 profit in the cycle or the account ends, then stop and wait. Request a payout of all profit on every payout day.
4. No hedging, no opposite positions across your accounts, no accounts in other people's names.

Sizing, step by step

20.1 The formulas

RISK

$room = balance - \$90,000$ $day\ room = \$5,000 - (start-of-day\ balance - current\ equity)$

$risk = \min(\$1,500, room - \$100, day\ room - \$200)$

STOP, LOTS, COST

$stop\ points = 0.75 \times hourly\ move$ $lots = risk \div (stop\ points \times V)$ $cost\ \$ \approx (spread + 0.6) \times lots \times V$

TARGET

$to\ go = phase\ (or\ cycle)\ target\ balance - balance$ $target\ \$ = \min(3 \times risk, to\ go + cost\ \$ + \$5)$

$target\ points = target\ \$ \div (lots \times V)$

20.2 Worked examples

Hourly move 85 points, so stop = 64 points. $V = \$1$ per point per lot (check yours), spread 1.4 points.

Situation	Balance	Room to floor	Day room	Risk	Lots	Cost	Target \$	Target pts	Win chance
Phase 1, start	\$100,000	\$10,000	\$5,000	\$1,500	23.43	\$47	\$4,500	192	25%
Phase 1, near target	\$108,800	\$18,800	\$5,000	\$1,500	23.43	\$47	\$1,252	53	55%
Phase 1, after a bad morning	\$95,400	\$5,400	\$1,400	\$1,200	18.75	\$38	\$3,600	192	25%
Phase 1, near the floor	\$90,900	\$900	\$5,000	\$800	12.50	\$25	\$2,400	192	25%
Phase 2, near target	\$104,000	\$14,000	\$5,000	\$1,500	23.43	\$47	\$1,052	45	59%
Funded, first cycle	\$100,000	\$10,000	\$5,000	\$1,500	23.43	\$47	\$1,052	45	59%
Funded, later cycle	\$100,000	\$10,000	\$5,000	\$1,500	23.43	\$47	\$4,500	192	25%

Win chance is the fair value: $stop \div (stop + target)$. Leverage check: $23\ lots \times 31,000 = \$726,000$ notional, far below the \$5,000,000 that 1:50 allows on 100K.

20.3 Why the cost is added near the target

Costs are charged on the full position, even when the remaining distance is small. If you are \$47 from the target and set a \$47 take-profit, the spread eats the whole win and you never cross the line. The simulation hit exactly this trap before the fix. Adding the trade's cost to the final target is what lets the account land on the target.

Stop, target and direction

21.1 Why 0.75 hourly moves

Chapter 10 found the best value per month for stops between 0.5 and 1 hourly moves. 0.75 sits in the middle of that plateau, so a small error in measuring the hourly move costs little. Below 0.5, costs rise faster than speed. Above 1.5, the plan slows sharply.

21.2 Why 1 : 3

Higher targets do not slow a phase down (Section 8.3) but reduce how many trades, and therefore costs, a phase needs. 1 : 2 and 1 : 3 performed about equally; 1 : 3 was slightly ahead. Do not go beyond 1 : 3: near the target most trades are capped anyway, and the real-data drift at very far targets is uncertain.

21.3 Direction

The plan assumes no edge. Any direction rule that is not systematically wrong gives the same expected value. A random choice (a coin flip or random number) is the honest baseline, and it is what was tested. If you use your own analysis instead, track whether it helps (Chapter 26).

21.4 Expected rhythm

With a 64-point stop and 192-point target, a trade lasts about 4–7 hours including waiting time. That is two to four trades per day. Phase 1 needs about 15 full-size trades on average, so most attempts are decided within a week.

Running it: by program or by hand

22.1 What the program does, step by step

Step	Action
1	If a position is open, do nothing until it closes.
2	If outside 01:00–20:00 UTC Monday–Friday, or within 15 minutes of a listed high-impact US release, wait.
3	Read balance, start-of-day balance and the current phase or cycle target. If the target is reached, stop for this phase or cycle.
4	Compute risk (Section 20.1). If the day room is below \$300, wait for the next FTMO day.
5	Compute stop points, lots, cost and target points.
6	Choose direction at random. Send a market order with stop and target attached.
7	Write a log line: time, balance, risk, lots, stop, target, direction, fill, result, cost.
8	Friday 20:30 UTC: close any open position. Funded account: close an open position 2 minutes before a listed release.

FTMO permits Expert Advisors. Keep the server load low (well under FTMO's 2,000 requests per day): this plan places only a few orders a day.

22.2 Test before using it on a paid account

Run the program on a free demo for at least two weeks. Check that every trade has both orders attached, that sizes match Section 20.2, and that the daily guard and Friday close fire.

22.3 By hand

Brackets keep working while you are away, so a person only needs to be present to *open* each trade. Opening trades only during 13:00–20:00 UTC (the US session) and letting them run gave, in simulation, about **+\$1,490 per attempt, 22 days per attempt and \$2,000 per month per slot**, with the first payout after about 29 days. That is about 15% less than the automated version.

Phases and timeline

Milestone (from the day you buy)	Typical day
Phase 1 decided (pass or fail)	day 5–6
Phase 2 decided; funded account issued (if passed)	day ~12
First payout received, fee refunded (if paid)	day ~27 (middle half: 25–29)
Funded account ends (on average after 1.7 payouts)	day ~39

Medians from 6,000 simulated attempts of the fast plan on FTMO 2-Step.

23.1 Phase 1

Chance of passing about 47%. Reaching +\$10,000 takes about 15 trades of \$1,500 at 1 : 3, so about five days. Passing requires 4 trading days; if you pass sooner, use tiny trades for the remaining days.

23.2 Phase 2

Chance of passing about 60%, usually within 3–5 days. FTMO then checks identity and issues the contract (1–3 days).

23.3 Never quit

A live account at balance x is worth $(x + \$10,000) \div (\text{target} + \$10,000)$ of the next stage. Quitting throws that away. The rule matters more in a fast plan: losing runs of 6–8 trades happen within a single day.

The funded account and payouts

24.1 First cycle: secure the refund

Trade the normal plan with the cycle target set to +\$1,000. The chance of reaching it before the floor is about 91%. Once the balance is \$101,000 or more, stop and wait for the first payout date (14 days after your first funded trade). Request the payout: 80% of the profit plus the €540 fee.

24.2 Later cycles: aim high

After the first payout, set the cycle target to +\$10,000. Each cycle then either reaches +\$10,000 (about one chance in two, after which you stop and wait) or ends the account. On each payout date, withdraw all profit; the balance returns to \$100,000 and the floor stays at \$90,000.

Why +\$10,000 rather than small, frequent payouts? With zero edge the total paid out averages 80% of the \$10,000 allowance whatever the policy (Chapter 5). Fewer, larger cycles finish sooner, which frees the slot for the next attempt. In simulation, +\$10,000 cycles gave \$2,351 per month against \$1,892 for +\$3,000 cycles.

24.3 What a funded account pays

On average \$7,225 (including the refund) over about 1.7 payouts. The spread is wide: about half of funded accounts pay only the first \$800 plus the refund, while about one in four pays \$16,800 or more.

Several accounts, other firms and the bankroll

25.1 Slots

A "slot" is one account you keep running: when an attempt ends, you buy the next. FTMO caps total allocation at \$400,000, so up to four 100K slots. Other firms have their own caps.

- **Same direction only.** If two of your accounts have trades open at the same time, they must not be opposite. The simplest rule is that all accounts copy the same random direction. That makes their results move together, which raises the swings.
- **No rolling.** FTMO lists "account rolling" as forbidden. Buy attempts on a schedule you set in advance, not as a reflex after a loss.
- **Several firms.** Running the same plan at The5ers, FundingPips and FTMO at once is not hedging, as long as directions match. Check each firm's rules on copying trades between your own accounts.

25.2 Expected income

Set-up (zero-edge model, payouts honoured)	EV per month	Fees per month
1 FTMO 2-Step slot	≈ \$2,400	≈ \$1,000
4 FTMO 2-Step slots (the \$400K cap)	≈ \$9,800	≈ \$4,000
1 slot each at The5ers, FundingPips, FTMO 1-Step, FTMO 2-Step	≈ \$11,500	≈ \$4,000

Treat these as upper estimates. They assume every payout is honoured, costs as measured, and no change in rules. Running many accounts with identical random trades is exactly the kind of activity a risk team looks at closely.

25.3 Bankroll rules

- Hold \$7,000–10,000 per slot before starting it.
- Fix in advance the number of months and attempts you will run.
- Withdraw payouts to a separate account; only the planned budget buys new attempts.
- If a slot's bankroll falls below 3 fees, pause that slot and review.

Records, tax and checks

26.1 Keep the log

The program's log (Section 22.1) is the record. Add every fee, every payout request and confirmation, and every message from the firm.

26.2 Check that the assumptions hold

Check	Expected	Stop and review if
Win rate of full 1 : 3 trades (after 400)	$\approx$ 25% before costs	Below 21%
Average cost per trade (spread, slippage and financing)	$\approx$ 3.5–4% of risk	Above 5.5%
Phase 1 pass rate (after 15 attempts)	$\approx$ 45%	2 or fewer passes (about a 1% chance if the plan is right)
Payouts honoured	All	Any refusal: stop at that firm and read the stated reason

26.3 Tax

Payouts are usually taxable income. Fees are often deductible. Keep every record and check your country's rules with a tax adviser.

Final checklist

- ☐ I am 18 or older, and each slot's bankroll (\$7,000–10,000) is money I can lose entirely.
- ☐ I have read the firm's current objectives, forbidden practices and payout terms.
- ☐ I have measured US100 cost (≤ 3 points round trip) and the value per point per lot on my platform.
- ☐ My program (or my manual routine) follows Chapter 19 exactly, and passed two weeks on demo.
- ☐ Risk never exceeds \$1,500 per trade; one position at a time; stop and target attached on entry.
- ☐ The daily guard, news rule and Friday close are in place.
- ☐ I never abandon a live account, never hedge, never hold opposite positions across accounts, never use other people's names.
- ☐ I understand that about three attempts in four lose the fee, that one month is almost always negative, and that the firm may refuse payouts or change its rules.

THE WHOLE DOCUMENT IN FIVE LINES

A zero-skill trade is a fair bet, so a phase passes with probability $B \div (A + B)$. A funded account pays out, on average, the split times the loss allowance. Time per phase grows with $(\text{stop} \div \text{risk})^2$, and cost with $1 \div (\text{reward-to-risk} \times \text{risk} \times \text{stop})$. So the fastest plan uses an efficient instrument (the Nasdaq), a short stop (0.75 hourly moves), 1 : 3 targets and the top of the firm's risk guidance (1.5%). That gives about +\$1,400 per FTMO attempt every 18 days, roughly \$2,400 per month per slot in theory. The firm's discretion is the one thing the maths cannot price.

Formula sheet and glossary

Quantity	Formula	FTMO 100K example
Zero-skill win probability	$p = S \div (S + T)$	1 : 2 → 33.3%
Pass probability, static floor	$P = B \div (A + B)$	Phase 1: 50%; Phase 2: 66.7%
Pass probability from balance x	$P(x) = (x + B) \div (A + B)$	x = -\$5,000: 25%
With overshoot	$P = (B + O_{\text{floor}}) \div (A + O_{\text{target}} + B)$	±\$4,800 fixed: 41%
Intraday trailing, continuous prices	$P = e^{-A/D}$	A = 1.5D → 22.3%
Funded identity	Withdrawn = trading P&L + (start – final balance)	E[withdrawn] = \$10,000
Funded value	$\approx \text{split} \times B \times (1 - \text{cost share}) + \text{refund} \times q$	≈ \$8,600
First-payout probability	$q = B \div (B + h)$	h = \$500 → 95.2%
EV per attempt	$-\text{Fee} + \Pi P_i \times (\text{funded value} - \text{activation})$	+\$2,235 (no costs)
Cost ratio	$\kappa = \text{cost pips} \div \text{stop pips}$	0.75 ÷ 55 = 1.4%
Expected trades per phase	$A \times B \div L^2$	L = \$1,000: 100
Expected cost per phase	$\kappa \times A \times B \div L$	L = \$1,000: ≈ \$1,400
Expected trades per phase (1 : k)	$A \times B \div (k \times L^2)$	1.5%, 1 : 3: ≈ 15
Duration of one bracket	$\approx k \times s^2 \div \sigma^2$	s = 0.75σ, 1 : 3: ≈ 1.7 active hours
Phase time and cost	$\propto (s \div L)^2$ and $\propto c \div (k L s)$	Chapter 8
Instrument efficiency	weekly move ÷ round-trip cost	US100 481, EURUSD 147, BTC 49–63
Tightest stop from leverage λ	$L \div (\lambda \times \text{size})$	1.5% at 1:50: 0.03%
EV per month per slot	EV per attempt ÷ attempt length	Fast plan ≈ \$2,400
Kelly bankroll for one attempt	$W \approx \sigma^2 \div \mu$	≈ \$4,100–6,000
Lots (EURUSD)	risk ÷ (stop pips × \$10)	\$1,000, 60 pips → 1.66

Glossary

Bold play	Sizing each bet so a win lands exactly on the target, using as few bets as possible.
Bracket	A trade with stop-loss and take-profit attached on entry.
Consistency rule	A limit on how much of total profit one day may contribute.
EOD trailing drawdown	A floor that rises with the highest end-of-day balance.

Expected value (EV)	The average result per repetition over many repetitions.
Fair bet / martingale	A bet with zero expected value; a sequence of such bets.
Floor	The balance at which the account is closed (\$90,000 for FTMO 100K).
Gambler's ruin	The problem of reaching one level before another; answer $B \div (A + B)$.
Intraday trailing drawdown	A floor that follows the highest live equity, including open profit.
Kelly criterion	The stake that maximises long-run growth of wealth.
Lot	Position unit; 1 standard EURUSD lot = 100,000 EUR, \$10 per pip.
Optional stopping theorem	A fair game stopped by a reasonable rule is still fair on average.
Overshoot	Ending beyond a barrier instead of exactly on it.
Pip	0.0001 in EURUSD.
Profit split	Your share of withdrawn profit (80% at FTMO).
Slippage	Being filled at a worse price than your order.
Spread	The gap between the buy and sell price.
Static drawdown	A floor fixed relative to the starting balance.

Every account type modelled

Zero skill, best sizing for each rule set, payouts honoured. "EV" uses 1% trading costs; "1%-risk EV" restricts every trade to 1% of the account (25% of the drawdown for futures). CFD accounts are 100K, futures 50K, prices in USD (EUR at 1.17). Rules as published September–October 2026. † marks rule sets partly inferred; instant-account values ignore payout caps.

Firm	Account	Price	Target / max loss	Funded	P(fund.)	Value	EV	1% risk
FTMO	1-Step	\$584	10/10% EOD trail +cons.	90% × \$10k	43%	\$9,376	+\$3,465	+\$2,646
Blue Guardian	Instant	\$779	instant	80% × \$6k	100%	\$3,920	+\$3,141	+\$3,062
Goat Funded	Instant GOAT	\$838	instant	80% × \$6k	100%	\$3,920	+\$3,082	+\$3,002
The5ers	High Stakes 2-Step	\$545	8/10% static → 5/10% static	80% × \$10k	36%	\$8,359	+\$2,490	+\$2,054
FundedNext	Stellar 2-Step	\$550	8/10% static → 5/10% static	80% × \$10k	36%	\$8,364	+\$2,486	+\$2,056
FundingPips	2-Step	\$529	8/10% static → 5/10% static	80% × \$10k	36%	\$8,281	+\$2,477	+\$2,043
Alpha Capital †	Alpha Pro 10%	\$497	10/10% static → 5/10% static	80% × \$10k	33%	\$8,313	+\$2,215	+\$1,794
FTMO	2-Step	\$632	10/10% static → 5/10% static	80% × \$10k	33%	\$8,442	+\$2,122	+\$1,697
Goat Funded †	2-Step Standard	\$594	10/10% static → 5/10% static	80% × \$10k	33%	\$7,840	+\$1,964	+\$1,556
FundedNext	Stellar Lite	\$400	8/8% static → 4/8% static	80% × \$8k	33%	\$6,272	+\$1,646	+\$1,398
Blue Guardian †	2-Step Pro	\$464	10/10% EOD trail → 10/10% EOD trail	85% × \$10k	24%	\$8,330	+\$1,556	+\$597
Maven †	2-Step	\$396	8/8% static → 5/8% static	80% × \$8k	30%	\$6,272	+\$1,490	+\$1,252
Alpha Capital †	Alpha Pro 8%	\$577	8/8% static → 5/8% static	80% × \$8k	30%	\$6,815	+\$1,473	+\$1,222
FundedNext	Stellar 1-Step	\$570	10/6% static	90% × \$6k	37%	\$5,292	+\$1,374	+\$1,194
FundingPips	1-Step	\$555	10/6% static	80% × \$6k	37%	\$5,120	+\$1,326	+\$1,158
FundingPips	Zero (instant)	\$499	instant	95% × \$5k	100%	\$1,679	+\$1,180	+\$1,113
E8 Markets †	E8 One (6% DD)	\$464	9/6% EOD trail	80% × \$6k	39%	\$3,920	+\$1,079	+\$514
Goat Funded †	3-Step GOAT	\$365	6/8% static → 6/8% static → 6/8% static	80% × \$8k	18%	\$6,272	+\$767	+\$598
FundingPips	2-Step Pro	\$399	6/6% static +cons. → 6/6% static +cons.	80% × \$6k	24%	\$4,704	+\$726	+\$635
Maven †	3-Step	\$269	3/3% static → 3/3% static → 3/3% static	80% × \$3k	12%	\$2,352	+\$14	+\$3
Alpha Capital †	Alpha Three	\$397	8/6% static → 8/6% static → 8/6% static	80% × \$6k	8%	\$4,704	−\$39	−\$95

Firm	Account	Price	Target / max loss	Funded	P(fund.)	Value	EV	1% risk
Lucid	Direct 50K (instant)	\$520	instant	90% × \$2k	100%	\$1,458	+\$938	+\$908
Apex	50K EOD	\$58 +\$139	\$3k/\$2k EOD trail	100% × \$2k	39%	\$1,620	+\$525	+\$352
Bulenox	50K Opt.2 (EOD)	\$175/mo +\$143k	\$3k/\$2.5k EOD trail +cons.	100% × \$2.5k	36%	\$2,028	+\$502	+\$482
Lucid	Flex 50K	\$130	\$3k/\$2k EOD trail	90% × \$2k	40%	\$1,458	+\$446	+\$274
Tradeify	Growth 50K	\$139	\$3k/\$2k EOD trail	90% × \$2k	39%	\$1,458	+\$435	+\$265
Tradeify	Lightning 25K (instant)	\$329	instant	90% × \$1k	100%	\$723	+\$394	+\$379
Lucid	Pro 50K	\$185	\$3k/\$2k EOD trail	90% × \$2k	39%	\$1,458	+\$389	+\$219
Topstep	Combine 50K (Standard)	\$49/mo +\$143k	\$3k/\$2k EOD trail +cons.	90% × \$2k	32%	\$1,470	+\$375	+\$316
Topstep	Combine 50K (No-Activation)	\$109/mo	\$3k/\$2k EOD trail +cons.	90% × \$2k	32%	\$1,470	+\$363	+\$298
My Funded Futures	Flex 50K	\$107/mo	\$3k/\$2k EOD trail +cons.	80% × \$2k	32%	\$1,296	+\$309	+\$252
Tradeify	Select 50K	\$159	\$3k/\$2k EOD trail +cons.	90% × \$2k	29%	\$1,458	+\$270	+\$245
The5ers †	Futures Basecamp 50K	\$100	\$3k/\$1.5k static	80% × \$1.5k	33%	\$980	+\$222	+\$202
Apex	50K Intraday	\$32 +\$99	\$3k/\$2k intraday	100% × \$2k	22%	\$672	+\$92	+\$86
Bulenox	50K Opt.1 (intraday)	\$175/mo +\$143k	\$3k/\$2.5k intraday	100% × \$2.5k	29%	\$848	+\$31	+\$21
Take Profit Trader	PRO 50K	\$170 +\$130	\$3k/\$2k EOD trail	80% × \$2k	40%	\$565	+\$2	-\$53
My Funded Futures	Rapid 50K	\$157/mo	\$3k/\$2k intraday	90% × \$2k	22%	\$604	-\$26	-\$31

Method and sources

How the numbers were produced

- **Exact results** (Chapters 3–6) follow from the formulas shown and were reproduced by a coin-flip simulation of 200,000 attempts (EV +\$2,272 ± 31 against the exact +\$2,235).
- **Evaluation phases for other firms** were solved by dynamic programming over balance and end-of-day high-water mark, with daily loss limits, best-day caps and a cost of $\kappa\sqrt{wl}$ per bracket.
- **Funded values** use the identity of Chapter 5 with lock levels and payout caps.
- **Real-data tests** use hourly EURUSD (yfinance), 18 Dec 2023 – 2 Oct 2026, as described in Chapter 14.

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Rules and prices change frequently. Every figure is a snapshot from October 2026 and should be re-checked against the firm's current terms.